FCPS ACE Italian 100 - Notes

SG

March 2026

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Preface

This document holds notes for the class I took in Spring 2026, *Italian 100 for Beginners and Travelers*. Each class is a chapter. The notes closely match what we cover in class, with additional comments, explanations for my own use, and examples I've picked up. The notes may (likely do!) contain mistakes.

Chapter 1

Jan 17

Topics *Nouns and adjectives. Quantitative adjectives. Negation. Helper verbs. Greetings.*

1.1 Grammar

1.1.1 Nouns - gender and articles

Italian nouns are gendered, masculine or feminine. Nouns ending *-o* are masculine; those ending *-a*, feminine. For example, (the) table, *il tavolo*, or (the) house, *la casa*. A few nouns end in *-e*, e.g., *il caffè*. Generally the *-e* nouns are masculine, but there are exceptions, such as *la stazione*.

Articles match the gender of the noun. A notable rule is that nouns that start with *z* or the combination *s* + consonant have different articles from the usual *un/il/la-*, as illustrated in Table 1.1. Plurals end in *-i* for masculine and *-e* for feminine, typically replacing the terminal *-o* and *-a* with *-o* and *-e* respectively.

masc.		**fem.**		Notes
a table	*un tavolo*	a house	*una casa*	
the table	*il tavolo*	the house	*la casa*	
the tables	*i tavoli*	the houses	*le case*	
an uncle	*uno zio*	an aunt	*una zia*	Nouns starting *z-*
the uncle	*il zio*	the aunt	*la zia*	
the uncles	*gli zii*	the aunts	*le zie*	
a receipt	*uno scontrino*	a station	*una stazione*	Nouns starting *s+consonant*
the receipt	*lo scontrino*	the station	*la stazione*	
the receipts	*gli scontrini*	the stations	*le stazione*	

Table 1.1: Articles

1.1.2 Adjectives

Adjectives have a base form ending with *-o* or *-e*. The former change their ending to *-a* when used with feminine singular nouns. For example *rosso*, red, is *rosso* for masculine and *rossa* for feminine singular nouns. On the other hand, an *-e* adjective like *grande* is just *grande* in the singular for both genders of noun. Whatever the adjective, there must be consistency between the noun and adjective

in terms of gender (masculine or feminine) and number (singular or plural). This includes the speaker when the adjective applies to them (i.e., the speaker is the noun).

Plural adjectives normally end like the same-gendered noun, e.g., masculine plural nouns end in *-i* most of the time, so adjectives describing such nouns end in *-i* as well: *tavolo* → *tavoli* and *tavolo rosso* → *tavoli rossi*. Similarly, *la donna alta* → *le donne alte*. But, of course there will be exceptions.

Examples

- The gelato is good.
  Il gelato è buono.
- The pizza is good.
  La pizza è buona.
- Claudio is tired.
  Claudio è stanco.
- Francesca is glad.
  Francesca è contenta.
- The coffee is good.
  Il caffè è buono.
- The pizza is not good.
  La pizza non è buona.

Most adjectives go after the noun, but adjectives of quantity (*molto*), possession (*mio, tuo, sua, etc.*) go before. Some adjectives that normally go after can go before to stress a point or to subtly alter the sense of the phrase. For example, compare "My car is new" with "My *new* car". The adjective *grande* is a case in point: when used after a noun, it describes 'big'-ness. Used before a noun, it describes 'great'-ness, as in, "London is a big city" vs. "London is a great city". As an adjective, *molto* is pluralized following the standard rules, e.g. *molti tavoli* or *molte stazioni*.

Examples

- The red house.
  La casa rossa.
- The new car.
  La macchina nuova.
- The *new* car.
  La nuova macchina.
- My wife.
  La mia moglie.
- His daughter.
  La sua figlia.
- Rome is a big city.
  Roma è una città grande.

- Rome is a great city. (As in, historic, magnificent, special)
  Roma è una grande città.
- Un tavolo caro.
  An expensive table.
- Umberto is my dear uncle. (Affection)
  Umberto è mio caro zio.

Italian seems to have a similar 'BANGS' rule to French: adjectives go after the noun unless they talk about **B**eauty, **A**ge, **N**umbers, **G**oodness, or **S**ize. See the Appendix.

1.1.3 Quantitative adjectives - *molto*

The word **molto** can act as an adjective, preceding a noun ("I have *a lot of* patience", "I don't do *much* sport"). In these cases it changes to match the noun.

However, *molto* can also act an adverb, ("Ravenna *is very* beautiful"), and an adverb-like modifier to a verb ("I like this car *a lot*"). In these cases, it does not need to change.

Examples

- I talk a lot.
  Io parlo molto.
  No change to *molto*. It is being used as an adverb to *parlo*.
- I don't talk much.
  Io non parlo molto.
  No change to *molto*. It is being used as an adverb to *parlo*.
- A lot of pasta, please.
  Molta pasta, per favore.
  Adjective for *pasta*, so *molto* must change to *molta* to match gender.
- (Claudio says . . .) I am very tired.
  Io sono molto stanco.
  No change to *molto*. It is an adverb to *sono*.
- (Francesca says . . .) I am very tired.
  Io sono molto stanca.
  No change to *molto*. It is an adverb to *sono*. (Notice that *stanca* does take the *-a* ending, as it is an adjective that applies to Francesca.)
- I have a lot of dogs.
  Io ho molti cani.
  Adjective for *cani*, so *molti* is required to match the plurality of *cane*.
- Italy is very beautiful.
  L'Italia è molto bella.
  Adverb for *è*, so no change to *molto* needed.
- The pizza is very good.
  La pizza è molto buona.
  Adverb for *è*, so no change to *molto* needed.

1.1.4 The simple negation - *non*

Statements can be negated by putting *non* between the subject and the verb.

Examples

- Francesca is not tired.
  Francesca non è stanca.
- The pizza is not good.
  La pizza non è buona.
- I am not tired, because I am not at work today.
  Io non sono stanco, perché io non sono a lavoro oggi.

1.2 Vocabulary

1.2.1 Verbs

1.2.2 The basics of *essere* and *avere*

Table 1.2 has the basics.

essere	*to be*	**avere**	*to have*
io	*sono*	**io**	*ho*
tu	*sei*	**tu**	*hai*
lui/lei	*è*	**lui/lei**	*ha*

Table 1.2: *essere* / *avere*, the basics, present tense

1.2.3 Words

See Table 1.3. (Note: in the table, and elsewhere in this document, gendered terms such as adjectives are presented in their masculine form by default.)

table	*tavolo*	kitchen table	*tavola*	wine	*vino*
pizza	*pizza*	house/home	*casa*		
good (thing)	*buono*	good (performance)	*bravo*	happy	*felice*
glad	*contento*	a lot of	*molto*	tired	*stanco*

Table 1.3: Some basic nouns and adjectives

1.2.4 Phrases - greetings

Greetings reflect the level of politeness, custom, and formality. See Table 1.4:

informal		**formal**		**Notes**
Hi	*Ciao*	Hello	*Salve*	
Good morning	*Buongiorno*	Good morning	*Buongiorno*	
...night	*Buonanotte*	...night	*Buonanotte*	
		...afternoon	*Buonpomeriggio*	
		...evening	*Buonasera*	
Bye	*Ciao, ciao*	Goodbye	*Arrivederci*	To one or more people
			Arrivederla	More formal, to one person
		Have a good day	*Buona giornata*	
		...night	*Buona serata*	

Table 1.4: Greetings

Chapter 2

Jan 24

No notes *No notes for this session, I lost them.*

Chapter 3

Jan 31

Topics *ATPG. Pronunciation. Possessive adjectives. Sentences.*

3.1 ATPG: All the Possibilities Game

tavolo	*table*	**gelato**	*gelato*
the	*il tavolo*	the	*il gelato*
a	*un tavolo*	a	*un gelato*
two	*due tavoli*	two	*due gelati*
good	*un buon tavolo*	good	*un buon gelato*
expensive	*un tavolo caro*	expensive	*un gelato caro*
new	*un nuovo tavolo*	new	*un nuovo gelato*
big	*un tavolo grande*	big	*un gelato grande*
my	*il mio tavolo*	my	*il mio gelato*
your	*il tuo tavolo*	your	*il tuo gelato*
his/her	*il suo tavolo*	his/her	*il suo gelato*

Table 3.1: ATPG

3.2 Pronunciation

Most consonants are pronounced as in English, but there are some rules to note:

1. M / N / P / Q / R / S / T are identical.
2. H at the start of a word is silent.
3. Vowels *a*, *e*, and *i* are pronounced like English 'ah', 'eh', and 'ih'.
4. Pairs of the same consonants are emphasized (which implicitly induces a tiny pause when spoken): *bello* is pronounced like *bel-lo*, not *belo*.
5. Letters *c*- and *g*- normally have a hard sound with their following vowel, e.g. *ca*, *go*, *gu* sound as they do in English.

6. However, the *ce* and *ci* pairs are 'ch'-sounds, like English 'cello' or 'cheese'.
7. Similarly, the *ge* and *gi* pairs are 'j'-sounds, like English 'general'.

Watch out for *ch* and *gh* combinations: the presence of the *h* makes for a hard sound. The food *bruschetta* is *broos-KET-ta* not *broo-SHET-uh*, no matter what the server at Olive Garden says. Another example: *pesce*, *PEH-sheh* is 'fish' but *pesche*, *PES-keh* is 'peaches'.

3.3 Grammar

3.3.1 More on stare and essere

- **stare** to be, to stay: *io sto*, *tu stai*. Remember, *stare* is never followed by an adjective.
- **essere** to be: *io sono*, *iu sei*
- **avere** to be: *io ho*, *tu hai*

Examples

- I am happy because this evening I am eating spaghetti carbonara.
  Io sono felice perché questa sera io sto mangiando spaghetti carbonara.
- You are not happy because you are cooking spaghetti carbonara.
  Tu non sei felice perché tu stai cucinando spaghetti carbonara.
- I am buying a coffee this morning.
  Io sto comprando un caffè questa mattina.
- You are tired, because you cook a lot.
  Tu sei stanca, perché tu stai cucinando molto.
- I am not happy because you have a lot of pasta and I do not.
  Io non sono felice perché tu hai molta pasta e io non ho.

3.3.2 Possessive adjectives

Possessive adjectives 'my', 'his' or 'hers', 'your', etc. are *mio*, *suo*, and *tuo* in their Italian base forms. They change ending just like other adjectives to match the noun being discussed. The phrase, "The my car is a beautiful car" is incorrect in English, but would be correct in Italian. Most of the time, we use articles with possessive adjectives.

Exception When we talk about family members, we omit the article.

Examples

- My car is a beautiful car.
  La mia macchina è una bella macchina.
- My brother is tired.
  Mio fratello è stanco.
- I am happy because I am driving my new car.
  Io sono felice, perché io sto guidando la mia nuova macchina.
- I am working with my computer this morning.
  Io sto lavorando con il mio computer questa mattina.

3.4 Vocabulary

3.4.1 Words

car	*macchina*	to cook	*cucinare*	to buy	*comprare*
morning	*mattina*	is	*è*	and	*e*
ceiling	*soffitto*	roof	*tetto*	wall	*muro*
gelato	*gelato*	because	*perché*	drawer	*cassetto*
road	*strada*	kitchen	*cucina*	class	*classe*
husband	*marito*	wife	*moglie*	delizioso	*delicious*
small	*piccolo*	angry	*arrabbiato*	name	*nome*

Table 3.2: Words to practice (Jan 31)

3.5 Homework

1. I'm happy because I'm studying Italian.
   Io sono felice perché io sto studiando italiano.
2. I'm not feeling well because I don't have a new car.
   Io non sto bene perché io non ho una nuova macchina.
3. I'm tired, because I'm drinking a lot of wine.
   Io sono stanco, perché io sto bevando molto vino.

4. I'm tired, because I'm working today.
   Io sono stanco, perché io sto lavorando oggi.

5. My brother isn't doing well, because my car is very small.
   Mio fratello non sta bene, perché la mia auto è molto piccola.

6. My wife is happy, because you are eating your pasta.
   Mia moglie è contenta, perché tu stai mangiando la tua pasta.

7. My sister is feeling unwell, because you are cooking spaghetti.
   Mia sorella sta male, perché tu stai cucinando spaghetti.

8. Aren't you driving your new car today?
   Tu non stai guidando la tua nuova auto oggi?

9. I'm buying my coffee.
   Io sto comprando il mio caffè.

10. I'm fine, because my husband is talking.
    Io sto bene, perché mio marito sta parlando.

Chapter 4

Feb 7

Topics *Grammar recap, More about adjectives, Possessive adjectives revisited*

4.1 Grammar

4.1.1 Review

- **essere**: *Io sono, tu sei, lui/lei è, noi siamo, voi siete, loro sono*
- **avere**: *Io ho, tu hai, lui/lei ha, noi abbiamo, voi avete, loro hanno*
- **stare**: *Io sto, tu stai, lui/lei sta, noi stiamo, voi state, loro stanno*

Examples

- You are happy because you stay at your home.
  Tu sei felice perché tu stai a tua casa.
- I am studying Italian today.
  Io sto studiando oggi.
- I am happy because I have a new car.
  Io sono felice perché io ho una nuova macchina.[1]
- I am happy because I have the car.
  Io sono felice perché io ho la macchina.
- The car is beautiful.
  La macchina è bella.
- I am talking now.
  Io sto parlando adesso.
- Claudio is driving now.
  Claudio sta guidando adesso.
- I am not happy because I am not eating pizza.
  Io non sono felice perché io non sto mangiando la pizza.

[1] *Macchina* is more common and less formal than *auto*, like 'car' vs. 'automobile' or 'vehicle'.

- You are sad because you do not have a new car.
  Tu sei triste perché tu non hai una nuova macchina / auto.

- I am good.
  Io sono bravo. (performance)

- I am a good dad.
  Io sono un buon papà.[2]

- I am good (when you are asked the question "how are you").
  Io sto bene.

- I am not happy because my wife is not cooking pizza this evening / tonight.
  Io non sono felice perché mia moglie non sta cucinando la pizza questa sera.

- This book is a good book.
  Questo libro è un buon libro.

4.1.2 Adjectives - *buono* / *bello* / *quello*

The adjectives *buono*, *bello*, and *quello* ('good', 'beautiful', and 'that', respectively) have a different spelling when they are used before a masculine noun. See Table 4.1. The adjectives are not shortened for feminine nouns.

base form	**becomes...**	*example*
buono	buon	*Un buon gelato*
bello	bel	*Un bel telefono*
quello	quel	*Quel tavolo*

Table 4.1: *Buono*, *bello*, and *quello* adjectives preceding masculine nouns

Examples

- Good day!
  Buon giorno!

- It's a good gelato.
  È un buon gelato.

- That gelato is good.
  Quel gelato è buono.

- It's a good pizza.
  È una buona pizza.

- This pizza is good.
  Questa pizza è buona.

[2] Accents matter ... *Papà* is 'dad' but *Papa* is 'Pope'.

4.1.3 Possessive adjectives

Saying, "The my car is red" is wrong in English. Italian on the other hand uses this construction, with the articles, a lot, and especially with possessive adjectives.

Possessive adjectives change ending to match the number and gender of the noun that they relate to, just like other adjectives. For example, *la sua macchina* can mean 'his car' or 'her car', because the *sua* matches the noun *macchina.*

adjective	**meaning**	*example*
mio	my, mine	*Il mio gelato*
mia		*La mia macchina*
tuo	your *sing.*	*Il tuo gelato*
tua	your *sing.*	*La tua macchina*
suo	his/her	*Il suo gelato*
sua		*La sua macchina*
nostro	our	*Il nostro vino*
nostra	our	*La nostra macchina*
vostro	your *pl.*[3]	*Il vostro vino*
vostra	your *pl.*	*La vostra macchina*

Table 4.2: Possessive adjectives

Remember that when we talk about family members (humans, not the dog!) we can drop the article, e.g., *mia moglie* instead of *la mia moglie*.

Examples

- My car is red.
  La mia macchina è rossa.
- His car is red.
  La sua macchina è rossa.
- Our son is very happy because he has a new car.
  Nostro figlio è molto felice perché lui ha una nuova macchina.
- My dog is very intelligent.
  Il mio cane è molto intelligente.
- My red wine is very good.
  Il mio vino rosso è molto buono.
- Your wine is very good. (Talking to a group.)
  Il vostro vino è molto buono.
- Your wine is very good. (Talking to an individual.)
  Il tuo vino è molto buono.
- My husband is not cooking pasta tonight.
  Mio marito non sta cucinando la pasta questa sera.

[3] Plural as in "you all's" or "y'all's"

4.2 Vocabulary

4.2.1 Verbs - *lavorare* and other *-are* examples

verb							
lavorare	to work	**io**	*lavoro*	**tu**	*lavori*	**lui/lei**	*lavora*
riposare	to rest		*riposo*		*riposi*		*riposa*
studiare	to study		*studio*		*studi*		*studia*
cucinare	to cook		*cucino*		*cucini*		*cucina*
mangiare	to eat		*mangio*		*mangi*		*mangia*
parlare	to speak		*parlo*		*parli*		*parla*

Table 4.3: Verbs: *-are* forms

4.3 Homework

1. I am busy. I am working now.
   Io sono occupato. Io sto lavorando adesso.
2. I am not well. I am resting.
   Io non sto bene. Io sto riposando.
3. I am sick (adjective). I am not working tonight.
   Io sto male. Io non sto lavorando questa sera.
4. I am not sick. I am working today.
   Io non sto male. Io lavoro oggi.
5. My son is studying Italian.
   Mio figlio sta studiando italiano.
6. My car is not fast.
   La mia macchina non è rapida.
7. My wine is very good.
   Il mio vino è molto buono.
8. I am very happy because my wife is cooking pizza tonight.
   Io sono molto felice perché mia moglie sta cucinando la pizza questa sera.
9. I am not happy because I am not eating pizza tonight.
   Io non sono felice perché io no sto mangiando la pizza questa sera.
10. She is very happy because she is not working today.
    Lei è molto felice perché lei non lavora oggi.
11. This pizza is very good. You are very good (performance).
    Questa pizza è molta buona. Tu sei molto bravo!
12. Your wife does not speak Italian. I speak Italian.
    Tua moglie non parla italiano. Io parlo italiano.

Chapter 5

Feb 21

Topics *ATPG. More about articles. Conversation.*

5.1 ATPG: All the Possibilities Game

tavolo	*table*	**casa**	*house*
the	*il tavolo*	the	*la casa*
a	*un tavolo*	a	*una casa*
good	*un buon tavolo*	good	*una buona casa*
my	*il mio tavolo*	good	*la mia casa*
expensive	*un tavolo caro*	expensive	*una casa cara*
his	*il suo tavolo*	new	*la sua casa*

Table 5.1: ATPG, Feb 21

5.2 Grammar

5.2.1 Articles - singular nouns

1. **il** for masculine nouns. *Il gelato*.
2. **la** for feminine nouns. *La macchina*.
3. **l'** for nouns starting with vowels. *L'arancia*, *l'albergo*.
4. **lo** for masculine nouns starting *z* or *s + consonant*.

5.2.2 Prepositions

A **preposition** is a word that shows the relation of one noun to another. For example, 'of', 'of the', 'on', 'with', or 'under'. The most flexible in everyday use is 'of / of the': *di, del, della*, expressing 'possession' and sometimes, 'specification'.

- Claudio's wine.
  Il vino di Claudio.
- Claudio's brother's wine.
  Il vino del fratello di Claudio.
- Claudio's mother's wine.
  Il vino della mamma di Claudio.
- A bottle of red wine.
  Una bottiglia di vino rosso.

on - *su, sul, sulla* When we have something 'over' something.

- The wine is on a table.
  Il vino è su un tavolo.
- The wine is on the table.
  Il vino è sul tavolo.
- The wine is on the car.
  Il vino è sulla macchina.

in - *in, nel, nella* When we have something 'in' something.

- The wallet is in the drawer.
  Il portafoglio è nel cassetto.
- The wallet is in the car.
  Il portafoglio è nella macchina.
- The wine is in his car.
  Il vino è nella sua macchina.

> If you are using the above prepositions with possessive adjectives, you do not need the article. Essentially the preposition includes it 'automatically', e.g. 'in his car' is *nella sua macchina* and not *nel la sua macchina* nor *nella la sua macchina*.

for, with, between - *per, con, tra* These prepositions are not combined with articles, and act as one word.

- I'm talking with my friend.
  Io sto parlando con il mio amico.
- You are driving between home and work today.
  Tu sta guidando tra casa e lavoro oggi.
- I have to work for money.
  Io devo lavorare per soldi.

5.3 Vocabulary

5.3.1 Words

puppy	*cucciolo*
cat	*gatto/a*
today	*oggi*
now	*adesso*

Table 5.2: Words to practice (Feb 21)

5.4 Conversation

1. Nice to meet you.
   Piacere.[1]

2. My name is Claudio.
   Il mio nome è Claudio.

3. I am Italian / American / Italian-American / half-Italian / English.
   Io sono italiano / americano / italo-americano / mezzo-italiano / inglese.

4. I work in Virginia.
   Io lavoro in Virginia.

5. I am retired
   Io sono in pensione.

6. I am in Italy for work.
   Io sono in Italia per lavoro.

7. I live in Virginia.
   Io vivo in Virginia.

8. I am on vacation for two weeks.
   Io sono in vacanza per due settimane.

9. I have two sons.
   Io ho due figli.

10. I have one daughter.
    Io ho una figlia.

11. This is my wife.
    Questa è mia moglie.

12. This is my son.
    Questo è mio figlio.

[1] Also: *È bello incontrare te* (not common).

13. This is my friend.
    Questo è il mio amico / Questa è la mia amica.

14. This is my mother's house.
    Questa è la casa di mia mamma.

15. I speak Italian.
    Io parlo italiano.

16. I am very happy.
    Io sono molto felice.

17. Italy is very beautiful.
    L'Italia è molto bella.

18. I have family in Italy.
    Io ho la famiglia in Italia.

5.5 Homework

1. I am very happy because I am eating Claudio's pizza.
   Io sono molto felice perché sto mangiando la pizza di Claudio.

2. Claudio is not happy because I am eating his pizza.
   Claudio non è felice, perché io sto mangiando la sua pizza.

3. Your glass of wine is on the table.
   Il tuo bicchiere di vino è sul tavolo.

4. His bottle of wine is very expensive.
   La sua bottiglia di vino è molto cara.

5. We are studying Italian with Claudio's book.
   Noi stiamo studiando italiano con il libro di Claudio.

6. My wallet is in the car.
   Il mio portafoglio è nella macchina.

7. This bread is very good because it is fresh.
   Questo pane è molto buono perché è fresco.

8. I am speaking with Claudio.
   Io sto parlando con Claudio.

9. I am sick. (Use the 'to stay' verb.)
   Io sto male.

10. I am sick. (Use the 'to be' verb.)
    Io sono malato.

Chapter 6

Feb 28

Topics *ATPG. Prepositions. Essere, avere, and stare verbs. Present conditional verbs. Restaurant conversation*

6.1 ATPG: All the Possibilities Game

prenotatzione	*reservation*
the	*la prenotatzione*
a	*una prenotatzione*
two	*due prenotatzione*
good	*una buona prenotatzione*
expensive	*una prenotatzione cara*
new	*una nuova prenotatzione*
big	*una prenotatizone grande*
my	*la mia prenotatzione*
your	*la tua prenotatzione*
his/her	*la sua prenotatzione*

Table 6.1: ATPG, Feb 28

Irregular nouns (starting with s + consonant or z), see Table 6.2:

[1] *Caro* means both 'costly' and 'beloved', like English 'dear'.
[2] Drop the article for family members: *mio zio, mia madre*, not *il mio zio, la mia madre*.

scontrino	*receipt*	**stato**	*state*	**zio**	*uncle*
the	*lo scontrino*	the	*lo stato*	the	*lo zio*
a	*uno scontrino*	a	*uno stato*	a	*uno zio*
two	*due scontrini*	two	*due stati*	two	*due zii*
good	*un buon scontrino*	good	*un buon stato*	good	*un buon zio*
expensive	*un scontrino caro*	expensive	*un stato caro*	dear[1]	*un caro zio*
new	*un nuovo scontrino*	new	*una nuovo stato*	new	*un nuovo zio*
big	*un scontrino grande*	big	*uno stato grande*	big	*un zio grande*
my	*il mio scontrino*	my	*il mio stato*	my	*mio zio*[2]
your	*il tuo scontrino*	your	*il tuo stato*	your	*tuo zio*
his/her	*il suo scontrino*	his/her	*il suo stato*	his/her	*suo zio*

Table 6.2: ATPG, Feb 28 - more unusual nouns

6.2 Grammar

6.2.1 Prepositions revisited

Prepositions express spatial or temporal relations (in, under, on, between, etc.) or have a semantic roles (of, for). They precede a noun. See Table 6.3.

with	*con*	for	*per*
between	*tra*	under	*sotto*
of	*di*[3]	of the	*del, della*
on	*su*	on the	*sul, sulla*
in the	*nel, nella*		

Table 6.3: Common prepositions

[3] A notable exception is *di* + *Italia*, which becomes *d'Italia*.

6.2.2 Prepositions with locations

Certain nouns, related to locations, require a specific preposition to represent 'in'/'at'. For example, Italian uses *a* for cities and towns, and *in* for states and countries. For example, *Io vivo a Denver, in Stati Uniti*. More details in Table 6.4.

in/at home	*a casa*	...the store	*al negozio*	...the restroom	*in bagno*
...work	*a lavoro*	...the restaurant	*al ristorante*	...the church	*in chiesa*
...Rome	*a Roma*	...the mall	*al centro commerciale*	...Italy	*in Italia*

Table 6.4: Location prepositions - special cases

Examples

- I'm very happy because I am eating a pizza with Claudio at the restaurant.
  Io sono molto felice perché sto mangiando la pizza con Claudio al ristorante.

- I'm at home because I am sick.
  Io sono a casa perché io sono malato.

- I'm not at work because I am unwell.
  Io non sono a lavoro perché io sto male.

- I'm buying lots of things at the shopping center.
  Io sto comprando molte cose al centro commerciale.

- I'm driving Claudio's Maserati because I'm going to the store.
  Io sto guidando la Maserati di Claudio perché io sto andando al negozio.

6.2.3 Using the verbs *stare* and *essere*

The concept of **to be** spans two verbs in Italian: *essere* and *stare*. For now, consider *essere* as expressing presence, or a state that would use an adjective, whereas *stare* expresses a location, an ongoing action, or a state that would use an adverb.

In colloquial US English, compare the response to the greeting 'How are you?':

- I am happy. (Verb *to be* + adjective *happy*.)
- I am doing well. (Compound verb *to be doing* + adverb *well*.)

In Italian:

- I am happy. (Verb: *Io sono* + adjective *felice*.)
- I am doing well. (Compound verb: *Io sto* + adverb *bene*.)

In the US, people sometimes say "I'm doing good" but this is, strictly, ungrammatical English, and it wold be a mistake to carry that forward into Italian. It would be <u>incorrect</u> to say this, because *stare* takes an adverb not an adjective:

- (Incorrect!) *Io sto buono.*

Examples

- How are you?
  Come stai?
- I am fine.
  Io sto bene.
- I am not well.
  Io non sto bene.
- I am unwell.
  Io sto male.
- I am sick.
  Io sono malato.
- I am happy.
  Io sono felice.
- We are happy.
  Noi siamo felice.

6.2.4 The present progressive tense: *stare* + gerund

The verb *stare* is used to construct the **present progressive** tense, where the speaker expresses something that is still happening. In English this would be, for example, "I am talking" in contrast to "I talk". The '-ing' form is a **gerund**. In Italian, gerunds end in *-ando* for *-are* verbs and *-endo* for *-ire* and *-ere* verbs .

Examples

- I am speaking.
  Io sto parlando.
- She is eating.
  Lei sta mangiando.
- We are speaking.
  Noi stiamo parlando.
- You are drinking.
  Tu stai bevendo.
- Claudio is driving his car.
  Claudio sta guidando la sua macchina.

6.3 Vocabulary

6.3.1 Verbs

essere	*to be*	**stare**	*to be/to stay*	**avere**	*to have*
io	*sono*	**io**	*sto*	**io**	*ho*
tu	*sei*	**tu**	*stai*	**tu**	*hai*
lui/lei	*è*	**lui/lei**	*sta*	**lui/lei**	*ha*
noi	*siamo*	**noi**	*stiamo*	**noi**	*abbiamo*
voi	*siete*	**voi**	*state*	**voi**	*avete*
loro	*sono*	**loro**	*stanno*	**loro**	*hanno*

Table 6.5: *essere, stare, avere*, Present tense

***Mangiare* - to eat** The verb *mangiare* is pretty simple in the **present** tense (Table 6.6). In the present **continuous** form (i.e., with *stare*), the gerund *mangiando* is used, e.g., *io sto mangiando*, I am eating. The present **conditional** form, 'would eat', is shown in the same table. For example you might say, in a restaurant, *Io mangerei la pasta*, literally, "I would eat the pasta", but more colloquially rendered as, "I'll have the pasta".

mangiare	*to eat*	*could eat*
io	*mangio*	*mangerei*
tu	*mangi*	*mangeresti*
lui/lei	*mangia*	*mangerebbe*
noi	*mangiamo*	*mangeremmo*
voi	*mangiate*	*mangereste*
loro	*mangiano*	*mangerebbero*

Table 6.6: *mangiare*, Present and present conditional tense

6.3.2 Words

See Table 6.7.

reservation	*prenotatzione*	table	*tavolo*	steak	*bistecca*
salad	*insalata*	local wine	*vino locale*	bottle	*bottiglia*
sparkling	*frizzante*	dessert	*dolce*	bill	*conto*

Table 6.7: Some restaurant terms

6.3.3 Phrases - in a restaurant

- Un tavolo per quattro persone, per favore.
  A table for four, please.
- Ho una prenotatzione.
  I have a reservation.
- Cosa mangiate?
  What would you like to eat?
- Io proverei ...
  I'll try ...
- Io mangerei ... questo piatto.
  I'll eat ... this dish. (E.g., pointing at something on the menu.)
- Cosa da bere?
  Something to drink?
- Tutto a posto?
  Everything OK?
- Più pane, per favore.
  More bread, please.
- Conto unico o separato?
  One check, or split?
- Il piacere è mio.
  The pleasure is mine.

6.4 Conversation: *Al ristorante*

Myself, *Io*, and a bunch of friends, *i miei amici*, show up at a restaurant. We are met by *il padrone* and are served by *il cameriere*.

Padrone *Buongiorno, tu hai una prenotatzione?*

Io *Sì, noi abbiamo una prenotatzione.*

Padrone *Perfetto.*

Cameriere *Cosa mangiate?*

Io *Io proverei le lasagne.*

amici *Un'insalata, per favore.*

amico *Io mangerei gli spaghetti carbonara con insalata.*

Io *La bistecca con patate.*

amico *Una pizza margherita, per favore.*

amica *Io proverei questo piatto, penne arrabbiata.*

amico *Io inizierei con un antipasto italiano.*

Cameriere *Perfetto! Grazie. Cosa da bere?*

Io *Due bottiglie di vino locale e due bottiglie di acqua frizzante.*

Padrone *Tutto a posto?*

Io *Sì, tutto a posto. Oh, più pane per favore.*

Cameriere *Caffè e dolce?*

Io *Caffè per favore.*

Io *Il conto, per favore*

Cameriere *Conto unico o separato?*

Io *Conto Unico. Io pago.*

Tutti *Grazie mille!*

Io *Il piacere è mio!*

Padrone *Grazie mille, e arrivederci.*

6.5 Homework

1. I would eat, but I do not have time.
   Io mangerei, ma non ho tempo.

2. The wine in this restaurant is very good.
   Il vino in questo ristorante è molto buono.

3. I am at the store now.
   Io sono al negozio adesso.

4. I'm studying with Claudio's book.
   Io sto studiando con il libro di Claudio.

5. This table is for my friend.
   Questo tavolo è per il mio amico.

6. My name is Claudio. Pleased to meet you.
   Il mio nome è Claudio. Piacere.

7. I'm busy now, because I am at the bank.
   Sono occupato adesso, perché sono in banca.

8. More water, please.
   Più acqua, per favore.

9. My friend has family in Italy.
   La mia amica ha famiglia in Italia.

10. I am on vacation for two weeks.
    Io sono in vacanza per due settimane.

Chapter 7

March 7

Topics *Modal verbs, shopping, recap of verbs, quello and questo, more and less - più*

7.1 Grammar

7.1.1 Modal verbs

A **modal verb** expresses sentiments like request, capability, and obligation. Used with the infinitive. Italian modal verbs: **volere** (to want), **potere** (to be able), **dovere** (to have to). E.g. 'want to eat' would be a conjugated form of *volere* 'want' with the infinitive *mangiare* 'to eat.' See Table 7.1.

potere	*to be able*	**volere**	*to want*	**dovere**	*to have to*
io	*posso*	**io**	*voglio*	**io**	*devo*
tu	*puoi*	**tu**	*vuoi*	**tu**	*devi*
lui/lei	*può*	**lui/lei**	*vuole*	**lui/lei**	*deve*
noi	*possiamo*	**noi**	*vogliamo*	**noi**	*dobbiamo*
voi	*potete*	**voi**	*volete*	**voi**	*dovete*
loro	*possono*	**loro**	*vogliono*	**loro**	*devono*

Table 7.1: Modal verbs, present tense

Examples

- I want a coffee.
  Io voglio un caffè.
- I want to buy a coffee.
  Io voglio comprare un caffè.
- I can pay.
  Io posso pagare.
- I have to pay.
  Io devo pagare.

7.1.2 Conditional usage

Just as in English, modal verbs are commonly expressed in a conditional form ("could, would, should"). E.g., it is more polite to say, "I would like" than "I want".

Examples

- I would like a coffee.
  Io vorrei un caffè.

- I would like to buy a coffee.
  Io vorrei comprare un caffè.

- Could I pay?
  Io potrei pagare?

- Should I pay?
  Io dovrei pagare?

7.1.3 This and that: *quello* and *questo*

We use **demonstrative adjectives** to show the thing we are talking about: 'this' or 'that' thing under discussion. As adjectives, they change ending to match the noun, e.g., 'this': *questo*, *questa*, 'that': *quello*, *quella*. See 7.2.

If *quello* is used before a masculine singular noun, it is shortened to *quel*, similarly to how *bello* becomes *bel*.

[Staa] has a good explanation.

	masc. sing.	**masc. pl.**	**fem. sing.**	**fem. pl.**
this, these	*questo, quest'*	*questi*	*questa, quest'*	*queste*
that, those	*quello, quell', quel'*	*quegli, quei*	*quella, quell'*	*quelle*

Table 7.2: Demonstrative adjectives

- I'd like that bottle please.
  Vorrei quella bottiglia, per favore.

- This book.
  Questo libro.

- I like this sparkling water.
  Mi piace questa acqua frizzante.

- Claudio is in that store.
  Claudio è in quel negozio.

- Claudio is in this store.
  Claudio è in questo negozio.

store	*negozio*	food store	*supermercato*	brand	*marca*
restaurant	*ristorante*	pharmacy	*farmacia*	post office	*ufficio postale*
closed	*chiuso*	open	*aperto*	hotel	*albergo*
sale	*saldi*	discount	*sconto*	receipt	*scontrino* [1]
small	*piccolo*	medium	*medio*	large	*grande*
suit (clothes)	*abito*	dress	*vestito*	pair of shoes	*paio di scarpe*
on sale	*in offerta*	special offer	*offerta speciale*		
size (clothes)	*taglia*	size (shoes)	*misura*		

Table 7.3: Shopping terms

7.2 Vocabulary

7.2.1 Words

7.2.2 Phrases - speaking about speaking Italian

- Io parlo italiano ma io sono un principiante.
  I speak Italian, but I'm a beginner.
- Puoi ripetere?
  Can you repeat?
- Per favore, parla lento.
  Please, speak slowly.
- Io parlo un po' italiano.
  I speak a little Italian. [2]

7.2.3 Phrases - more and less

The word **più** is used with nouns or adjectives to express more-ness. This can go in both directions, e.g. 'more small' and 'more big'. In the other direction, *meno* represents less-ness.

- More water, please.
  Più acqua, per favore.
- Smaller.
  Più piccolo.
- Bigger.
  Più grande.

7.3 Conversation: *Al negozio*

Luigi Good morning. Can I help you?
Buongiorno. Posso aiutare?

[1] It is expected practice to ask for a receipt for a transaction, and in fact you may be asked to produce one after leaving a business by the authorities.

[2] Contrast *po'*, expressing a limit, to *poco*, representing quantity ('few').

Francesca Hello. Yes. I want to buy a pair of shoes, please.
Salve. Sì. Io vorrei comprare un paio di scarpe, per favore.

Luigi What size?
Quale misura?

Francesca Forty, thanks. I need to also buy an elegant dress for this evening.
40, grazie. Io devo comprare anche un vestito elegante per questa sera.

Luigi What size?
Quale taglia?

Francesca Smaller. Medium please. How much does it cost?
Più piccolo. Media per favore. Quanto costa?

7.4 Homework

1. I am very happy because I am eating Claudio's pizza.
   Io sono molto felice perché sto mangiando la pizza di Claudio.

2. Claudio is not happy because I am eating Claudio's pizza.
   Claudio non è felice, perché io sto mangiando la sua pizza.

3. Your glass of wine is on the table.
   Il tuo bicchiere di vino è sul tavolo.

4. His bottle of wine is very expensive.
   La sua bottiglia di vino è molto cara.

5. We are studying Italian with Claudio's book.
   Noi stiamo studiando italiano con il libro di Claudio.

6. My wallet is in the car.
   Il mio portafoglio è nella macchina.

7. This bread is very good because it is fresh.
   Questo pane è molto buono perché è fresco.

8. I am speaking with Claudio.
   Io sto parlando con Claudio.

9. I am sick. (Using the 'to stay' verb)
   Io sto male.

10. I am sick. (Using the 'to be' verb)
    Io sono malato.

Chapter 8

Mar 28

Topics *Irregular verbs: fare and andare. Imperative tense. Pronunciation tips, directions, need. Homework review.*

8.1 Grammar

8.1.1 Irregular verbs: *fare* and *andare*

Some verbs you just have to know. Two important ones are *fare*, to do/to make, and *andare*, to go. Fare is used in lots of idiomatic expressions. See Table 8.1.

	fare	**andare**
io	*faccio*	*vado*
tu	*fai*	*vai*
lui/lei	*fa*	*va*
noi	*facciamo*	*andiamo*
gerund	*facendo*	*andando*

Table 8.1: Some restaurant terms

Examples

- I'm taking a shower.
  Io faccio la doccia
- What do you do for work?[1]
  Cosa fai per lavoro?
- I'm very happy because I'm making pizza this evening.
  Io sono molto felice perchè io faccio la pizza questa sera.
- Are you making lasagne tonight?
  Tu stai facendo lasagne questa sera?

[1] Culturally, asking about your job is not really done in Italy.

- We are making a cake for you.
  Noi facciamo una torta per te.

- I'm going to the store.
  Io sto andando al negozio.

- I need to go to the store.
  Io ho bisogno di andare al negozio.

- Are you going on vacation?
  Tu vai in vacanza? or *Tu stai andando in vacanza?*

8.1.2 The imperative tense

This verb form is used to offer suggestions or commands from the speaker to a listener. Consequently, it only exists in the second person and first person plural. For example, in Table 8.2, the commands would be "Speak!" and "Let's talk!"

	present	**imperative**
io	*parlo*	
tu	*parli*	*parla*
lui/lei	*parla*	
noi	*parliamo*	*parliamo*
voi	*parlate*	*parlate*

Table 8.2: Comparison of present and imperative verb tense, with *parlare*

Examples

- Eat! Eat!
  Mangia, mangia!

- Let's go!
  Andiamo!

- Drive!
  Guida!

- Listen!
  Ascolta!

- Wait!
  Aspetta!

- Get in! (e.g., a car)
  Entra!

8.2 Pronunciation review

See Section 3.2 from the Jan 31 class as well.

1. Emphasize the double consonants: *bello* is not said the same as *belo*!
2. Understand the soft sounds . . . : *ci*, *ce*, *gi*, *ge* get the same consonantal sounds as English 'ch' and 'j'.
3. . . . they are different from the hard sounds: *cu*, *co*, *ca*, *gu*, *go*, *ga*.
4. Mnemonic: adding *h* adds a hard sound, e.g., *ce* → *che* changes sound from 'cheh' → 'keh'.[2]
5. Most consonants sound the same, e.g., *t, m, n, p, q, r, s*.
6. The usual place for stress is on the penultimate syllable. Accents can override this, e.g., in *caffè*.

8.3 Vocabulary

8.3.1 Words

roof	*tetto*
desk	*scrivania*
wall	*muro*
ceiling	*soffitto*
floor	*pavimento*
ticket	*biglietto*
who	*chi*

Table 8.3: Vocab review, Mar 28

8.3.2 Phrases - Getting directions

When you ask for directions, e.g., by asking, "*Dov'è il Colosseo?*", you are likely to get back a sequence of instructions in the imperative tense: 'turn left at the lights', 'go straight', etc. The same works in Italian.

infinitive	**imperative**	Example	
andare	*vai*	*Vai diritto*	Go straight
girare	*gira*	*Gira a destra*	Turn right
svoltare	*svolta*	*Al semaforo, svolta a sinistra*	At the lights, turn left
tornare	*torna*	*Torna indietro*	Turn around
passare	*passa*	*Passa la chiesa*	Pass the church

Table 8.4: Some imperatives, used in giving directions

Some other useful words for directions (8.5):

[2] Classic example: *pesce* 'pes-sheh', fish vs. *pesche*, 'pes-keh', 'peach'.

left	*a sinistra*
right	*a destra*
near	*vicino*
far	*lontano*
after	*dopo*
intersection	*incrocio*
traffic light	*semaforo*
stop (transit)	*fermata*

Table 8.5: Some common terms, used in giving directions

Examples

- At the intersection, turn left.
  Al semaforo, gira a sinistra.
- This is my stop.
  Questa è la mia fermata.
- The church is not far away.
  La chiesa non è lontana.
- At the next intersection, turn right, then left.
  Al prossimo incrocio, gira a destra, e poi a sinistra.
- Turn around at the bank, and go straight ahead.
  Torna indietro al banca, e vai diritto.

8.3.3 *avere bisogno di* - to have need of

Use the three word combination of *avere*, *bisogno*, and *di* to express 'to have a need of' something.

- I need a coffee.
  Io ho bisogno di un caffè.

8.4 Homework

1. I would drive but I am very tired.
   Io guiderei, ma sono molto stanco.
2. I want to buy the wine at the restaurant.
   Io voglio comprare il vino al ristorante.
3. I can't talk now. I am working.
   Io non posso parlare adesso. Io sto lavorando.
4. I would like to order, please.
   Vorrei ordinare, per favore.
5. More wine, please.
   Più vino, per favore.

6. Nice to meet you. My name is (your name).
   Piacere. Il mio nome è Shriman.

7. Hello. I would like to buy a bottle of wine for my friend.
   Salve. Vorrei comprare una bottiglia di vino per il mio amico.

8. Where is a bank?
   Dov'è una banca?

9. I am fine, thank you. And you?
   Io sto bene, grazie. E tu?

10. I am on vacation for one week.
    Io sono in vacanza per un settimana.

11. The wine is in the car.
    Il vino è nella macchina.

12. Is there a discount?
    C'è uno sconto?

13. I am studying Italian in Virginia.
    Io sto studiando italiano in Virginia.

14. I can't. I am at work now.
    Non posso. Io sono a lavoro adesso.

15. Hello. We have a reservation for two.
    Salve. Noi abbiamo una prenotazione per due.

16. The pizza in this restaurant is very good.
    La pizza in questo ristorante è molto buona.

17. I would like the bill, please. We are ready.
    Vorrei il conto, per favore. Siamo pronti.

18. My friend does not speak Italian. I speak a little Italian.
    Il mio amico non parla italiano. Io parlo un po' d'italiano

19. I would try this dish. Thank you.
    Io proverei questo piatto. Grazie.

20. Can I have a bottle of natural water, please?
    Posso avere una bottiglia d'acqua naturale, per favore?

Chapter 9

Apr 11

Topics *Numbers. Sentence review. -are verb form recap*

9.1 Grammar

9.1.1 Numbers

See Table 9.1. Numbers are one of those things you just have to learn.

#		#		#	
0	*zero*	**7**	*sette*	**14**	*quattordici*
1	*uno*	**8**	*otto*	**15**	*quindici*
2	*due*	**9**	*nove*	**16**	*sedici*
3	*tre*	**10**	*dieci*	**17**	*diciassette*
4	*quattro*	**11**	*undici*	**18**	*diciotto*
5	*cinque*	**12**	*dodici*	**19**	*diciannove*
6	*sei*	**13**	*tredici*	**20**	*venti*

Table 9.1: Numbers zero through twenty

Once the base forms are learned, e.g., *venti*, 'twenty', compound forms like 'twenty-one' are easy to figure out.

#		#	
10	*dieci*	**70**	*settanta*
20	*venti*	**80**	*ottanta*
30	*trenta*	**90**	*novanta*
40	*quaranta*	**100**	*cento*
50	*cinquanta*	**1000**	*mille*
60	*sessanta*		

Table 9.2: Multiples of ten and one hundred

For large numbers (thousands), you would speak the thousands part, then *e*, and then the remainder. Phone numbers can be read out number by number: 'seven-zero-nine' / *'sette-zero-nove'*

style.

Examples

- Twenty-five
  Venticinque
- One hundred and twenty-five
  Centoventicinque
- €2350
  Due milla e trecentocinquanta euro.

Note: The word 'euro' is pronounced like *Eh-OO-roh*, not *YOO-roh*.

9.1.2 Verb recap: the regular *-are* form

See Table 9.3 as an example. The regular verbs ending *-are* can be conjugated, in their present tense, by stripping off the *-are* ending and adding *-o, -i, -a, -iamo, -ate, -ano*. For example, *io porto*, 'I bring' from *portare*, 'to bring, to deliver'.

portare	*to bring*
io	*porto*
tu	*porti*
lui/lei	*porta*
noi	*portiamo*
voi	*portate*
loro	*portano*

Table 9.3: An example of a regular *-are* verb: *portare*

Chapter 10

Apr 18

Topics *tbd...*

Appendix

Class dates

Jan	~~11~~	17	24	31
Feb	07	~~14~~	21	28
Mar	07	~~14~~	~~21~~	28
Apr	~~04~~	11	18	~~25~~

Table 1: Class dates

Resources

Things I have found during class. (References should be clickable.)

Apps

- [Duo]: Wasn´t very useful to me, felt like I stopped learning and started just going through the motions.
- [Mem]: I liked the short video clips and the AI tutor.

Books

- [Rag63]: Very old-fashioned, but the book is slim and quick to read.

Online

- [Can24]: Blog site with friendly explanations, e.g. of *grande*.
- [Cap25]: I found *molto* confusing, but this site explained it well.
- [Stab]: Explanation of adjectives and their placement. Bit dry.
- [Que25]: Comparing *essere* and *stare* in a simple way.
- [Wor]: I use this site all the time to look things up, super useful multi-lingual dictionary and verb tool.

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